

and well-being. Once you have identified your core values, draw up a code of conduct: a rulebook for how you and your employees will act. Everyone must understand how you expect them to operate. You can share your code of conduct with suppliers and customers.

Whatever you decide to focus on, your code of conduct must be genuine. If you tell people you are an employer who values their staff

but then you force people to work long hours, potential employees will hear about it and go elsewhere. Make sure you can do what you promise because it takes a long time to build a reputation and only a short time to destroy it.

Making the right choices

Your ethical stance might sometimes lead to difficult choices. If your code of conduct allows you

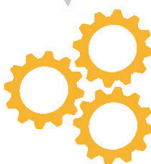
to buy only from other businesses that trade ethically, then you may have to pay more for your goods. If you run a clothing store, for example, you will not want to buy cheaper garments from factories with poor ethical standards. However, customers are usually prepared to pay a little more when they buy from companies they trust to take this ethical approach, so you may not lose out financially.



Suppliers and customers

Always choose to buy from suppliers who have an ethical program in place.

Buy locally to support the business community. Strive to be open, honest, and transparent with your customers and build personal relationships with them.



Operations

Ensure that all operations in your business are ethical and transparent.

Check that every employee and supplier involved in your business understands and is working to maintain your ethical standards.



CASE STUDY

Solarkiosk AG

Start-ups like Solarkiosk place ethics at the heart of their business. Founded in 2011, the German solar technology firm is "driven by the mission of universal access to energy." About 20 percent of the world's poorest people live off-grid. Solarkiosk's flagship product is the E-HUBB, a solar-powered mobile kiosk that generates electricity. Kiosks are used to charge phones or cool medicines, but they also act as small businesses.

"Real integrity is doing the right thing, knowing that nobody's going to know whether you did it or not."

Oprah Winfrey, media mogul